Vacation House Checks

211.1 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This protocol outlines the process by which the department receives requests for vacation house-checks from community members, documents and tracks them, and conducts them.

Vacation house-checks refer to when department members visit and inspect a community member's private residence while they are away and/or out of town for an extended period of time (usually several days to weeks) to ensure nothing appears out of order or merits further investigation. These checks serve an important purpose in providing service to the community, safeguarding property, and increasing overall community safety through high-visibility department efforts.

211.2 RECEIPT AND DOCUMENTATION OF REQUESTS FOR VACATION HOUSE CHECKS

1. Vacation House Checks are submitted online through the Department website, under the "Police Services" section.
    (a) When a requesting community member lacks internet access or is unfamiliar with navigating the online request process, they should be directed to call the Support Services Administrative Assistant to submit the request over the phone.
2. Once received, the Support Services Administrative Assistant will email the request to Dispatch Supervision, the Explorer Program Supervision, and the Field Operations Administrative Assistant.
3. The Dispatch Supervisor or assigned personnel will verify that the involved address is an existing 'Premise' in RIMS.
    (a) If not, Dispatch will create a new premise for the address and enter information applicable to the premise.
4. The Dispatch Supervisor or assigned personnel will enter information from the Vacation House Check request to the Premise file for the address in RIMS.
5. Dispatch will create a 'Code 14' incident in RIMS.
6. "Vacation Check" will be listed in the narrative of the incident, and the information from the Vacation House Check request will be attached as a PDF.
7. Dispatch will close out the incident with a Canceled Disposition.
8. The Explorer Program will print out the information and maintain an updated folder of active locations to check.

211.3 CONDUCTING CHECKS

1. The Department Explorer Program will conduct these checks on a reasonable basis, but ideally no less than once per week, as workload allows.

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(a) The Explorer Program will coordinate with Field Operations leadership to secure vehicles to use. Ideally, staff conducting these checks will use vehicles that are clearly marked as department-associated but not patrol officer vehicles.

(b) When the Explorer Program is unable to conduct these checks, they will notify the Field Operations Administrative Lieutenant to request Field Operations members assist in doing so.

(a) In such instances, community service officers should be assigned to conduct the checks. If they are unavailable, officers will be so assigned.

2. Staff conducting these checks will have a police radio and will have been trained on proper radio operations.

3. They will broadcast on the police radio that they are on a 'Code 14' at the respective address.

4. They will conduct a check as appropriate, based on the specific location, which may include the following actions:

(a) Walking the front of the property

(b) Inspecting any visible doors, windows, and other access points to see if they look secure and intact.

(c) Checking to see if there are vehicles present on the property (and comparing those to what was provided in the Vacation House Check request)

(d) Any other notable or significant observations.

5. If anything is found to be amiss or of concern, staff should use the police radio to summon on-duty uniformed personnel.

6. If nothing is amiss, staff shall advise Dispatch they have completed the check and broadcast "10-8, completed."

7. Dispatch will close the incident out with a Completed Disposition.

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